

SHRUTHI SANKARANARAYANAN

Höhrerstraße 48, 56179 Vallendar, Germany | +49 155 60416431 | s.sankaranarayanan@whu.edu

Zalando SE
Berlin, Germany

Vallendar, January 11th, 2025

Application for Sports Buying and Merchandising Internship – starting from May 1st, 2025

Dear Recruiting Team,

I am currently in the first semester of my Master's in International Business at WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management. I would like to apply for the Sports Buying and Merchandising Internship at Zalando and am available from May through August 2025.

My academic journey at WHU has been instrumental in shaping my approach to strategy, business development and problem-solving. In particular, my course in International Strategy and Data analytics have provided an in-depth understanding of various business models and strategic frameworks. Through case studies of organizations such as Coca-Cola, Boeing, and Hindalco, I explored how strategic decisions influence competitive positioning and organizational success. This structured, forward-thinking approach to analyzing complex challenges deeply resonated with me and reinforced my passion for strategy. Earning top marks (1.0) in the course and being commended for my insights reflects my analytical and structured problem-solving capabilities—skills that I am eager to apply to high-impact projects at Zalando. I feel equipped with the ability to analyze business performance, interpret customer behavior, and create actionable strategies.

In my previous role as Sales Team Lead at Pickyourtrail, I gained valuable experience in planning and coordinating tasks across a team. My different responsibilities taught me the importance of considering each team member while adopting a team-wide strategy that kept everyone aligned and motivated. Each month, I reviewed performance data and client conversion metrics to highlight which destinations were driving the best results. This analysis helped me focus our efforts on high-potential destinations and adapt our sales pitches to match client preferences and seasonal demand. By guiding my team in these efforts, I learned how strategic insights can be practically applied to achieve measurable goals—a skill I am eager to develop further in this role. I also worked closely with team members who needed extra support, looking into their performance metrics to identify improvement areas and addressing any other factors that might impact their motivation. This experience taught me the value of combining strategy with practical team management—a skill set that aligns well with Zalando's focus on high-impact, collaborative work environments.

At Pickyourtrail, I also developed innovative client acquisition strategies, targeting high-potential markets identified through market analysis of top selling destinations experiencing heavy tourism. This experience sharpened my ability to analyze market opportunities and devise actionable strategies to drive business growth.

These experiences have equipped me with skills in customer-centric communication, data analysis, and teamwork—key competencies I believe will contribute to enhancing Zalando's sports onsite experience and supporting partnerships with brands like Nike, adidas, and Salomon.

What excites me most about this role is Zalando's innovative approach to transforming online sports retail into an inspiring, magazine-like experience that educates and engages customers. As someone with a strong interest in sports and an understanding of the emotional connection customers share with their favorite brands, I am eager to contribute my skills and enthusiasm to this dynamic team.

Zalando's inclusive culture and commitment to innovation resonate deeply with my personal and professional values. I am confident that my combined academic and professional background, along with my passion for sports and strategic thinking, will enable me to make a meaningful contribution to Zalando's journey.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I am excited about the opportunity to learn from the team at Zalando's, and I look forward to discussing my fit for the program in further detail.

Sincerely,
Shruthi Sankaranarayanan